



YOU SAID IT

help Arpit, a child suffering from cerebral palsy. I am sure this innovation would have gone unnoticed otherwise.

I can understand the problems faced by a child like Arpit better than others. I myself suffer from cerebral palsy (CP), which affected my legs very early on in life. I have spent a major part of my childhood in rehabilitation centres along with other CP patients. However, being luckier than most, I was able to live a comparatively normal life that included going to normal schools, etc. I have now completed a B.Tech degree in Information Technology.

It has always been a dream of mine to help people like Arpit to have a normal life, which I was lucky enough to enjoy. I am deeply touched and motivated by the efforts of Arun Mehta and would like to convey the same to him through this column of the magazine.

I would also like to know more about Mehta's project and would like to get involved in it, if possible. Once again I would like to applaud your efforts in highlighting this innovation to the public.

—Nithin Bose,
nithinbose@gmail.com

ED: We are really happy to know that you liked reading the article 'Technology To Aid The Disabled'.

Your own story of courage and how you have come up in life despite the odds is also very inspiring.

We have forwarded your note to Arun Mehta, who would be

the best person when it comes to sharing details about his project and apprising you on how you can contribute to it.

We wish you all the best in this endeavour.

A few concerns and suggestions related to FOSS gadgets



I have been a regular reader and subscriber of your magazine for several years now. At the outset, I would like to say that I am very appreciative of your efforts towards producing a magazine as brilliant as *LFY*. Your sincere efforts are helping to get FOSS popularised and adopted in the mainstream.

I would also like to bring to your attention a few things I am unhappy about:

1. Although your OSS Gadget list is a nice effort, it does not include many of the 100 per cent FOSS gadgets such as Ben NanoNote, the Lemote laptop and WikiReader, to name a few.
2. There are no articles or tutorials that feature interesting hacking techniques related to the above mentioned gadgets.
3. I would also like to make another suggestion related to content. Can you include 'Do It Yourself' articles linked to Beagle Board or Hawkboard. For example, an article on creating a simple 17.7 cm (7 inch) eBookreader or something useful. I know it may seem as if I am asking for too much, but ultimately, I look at *LFY* for

technical guidance whenever things get difficult for me.

4. Another suggestion is to offer an electronic version of *LFY* at a reduced cost. I am sure there would be many like me who would like to opt for such a scheme. It will help us save a lot of paper and ink while enabling us to read *LFY* on a variety of devices. Of course, DRM will be a big no no :-)

—Nirmal Garia,
nirmal.garia@gmail.com

ED: Thanks a lot for your words of appreciation. Since you have numbered your queries, we will try to address them in the same sequence.

As regards the first point, in the OSS Gadgets feature, our aim is to publish the latest OSS-based products that are readily available in India. We had included a 100 per cent FOSS gadget called OpenMoko Neo Free Runner a few editions back. The phone is available only with a dealer based in Jaipur. More details are available on: <http://www.idasystems.net/>

The dealer also stocks most of the other gadgets that you have named in your note. But again, they do not have any other branches other than the one in Jaipur. Our goal is also to refresh the list with the newest launches, and also do away with products that are either not available, readily, or not much in demand. For instance, last month, we did away with the Nokia N900, which is again a Linux based phone, but